



INTERNAL SECURITY

MODULE - 9

LEFT-WING EXTREMISM



Russian Revolution

Combination of Peasant Movement and armed struggle against Czar

Ideological roots

Naxalism

Naxalites are far-left radical communist who derive their political ideology from the teachings of Mao Zedong

Fidel Castro

Mao Zedong

Maoism

"Political power grows out of the barrel of a gun"



LEFT-WING EXTREMISM

WHAT IS LEFT-WING EXTREMISM OR NAXALISM?



- 1 The term Naxal derives its name from the village Naxalbari of district Darjeeling in West Bengal, where the movement originated in 1967 under the leadership of Charu Majumdar, and Kanu Sanyal and Jangal Santhal.

- 2 It refers to the use of violence to destabilise the state through various communist guerrilla groups.
- 3 Naxalites are far-left radical communists who deliver their political ideology from the teachings of Mao Zedong, a Chinese revolutionary leader.
- 4 They have been operating in various parts of the country since the early 1970s.

Former Prime Minister Manmohan Singh described Naxalism as the most significant threat to internal security being faced by the country today.

LEFT-WING EXTREMISM

PHILOSOPHICAL BACKGROUND OF NAXALISM AND MAOISM

The ideological basis for these violent movements was provided by the writings of Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels. This ideology is commonly called Communism/Marxism



- 1 Leftist ideologies believe that all existing state structures in an elitist/capitalist society are exploitative by nature and only a revolutionary change can end this exploitation.

- 2 They suggest removal of the capitalist bourgeois elements.

- 3 Maoism is a doctrine that teaches to capture state power through a combination of armed insurgency, mass mobilisation and strategic alliances.

- 4 Maoism glorifies violence and calls this process as “Protracted People’s War”.

LEFT-WING EXTREMISM

Tebhaga movement: The communist movement started in WB with the intent of reducing the land revenue reduced from $1/2$ to $1/3^{\text{rd}}$.

1946

Telangana movement:

- Led by the people against the atrocities of the Nizam rule
- Acquired radical dimensions in due progress

Kisan Sabhas:

- Were started by CPI as an informal peasant movement.
- Intent was to find the political solution for farmers problems

1951

1959



LEFT-WING EXTREMISM

- Indo-China war
- Was viewed as a struggle between socialist country against capitalist India.

- CPI(M) participated in polls and formed a coalition United Front Government in West Bengal
- Charu Majumdar accused CPI(M) of betrayal



1962

1964

1967

25th May, 1967

- Growing dissent within the party lines
- Formation of new party called Communist Party of India (Marxist).

- The rebel cadres led by Charu Majumdar launched a peasants uprising at Naxalbari

LEFT-WING EXTREMISM

PHILOSOPHICAL BACKGROUND OF NAXALISM AND MAOISM

4

- Fear psychosis
- Denies democracy and development to tribals.
- Disrupts state structures.

3

Anti Capitalism: It fundamentally considers the industrial-rural divide as a major division exploited by capitalism. It tries to setup egalitarianism as opposed to free market ideology.



CHARACTERISTICS OF MAOISM



1

Political Orientation: It emphasises violent struggle of people against exploiting classes.



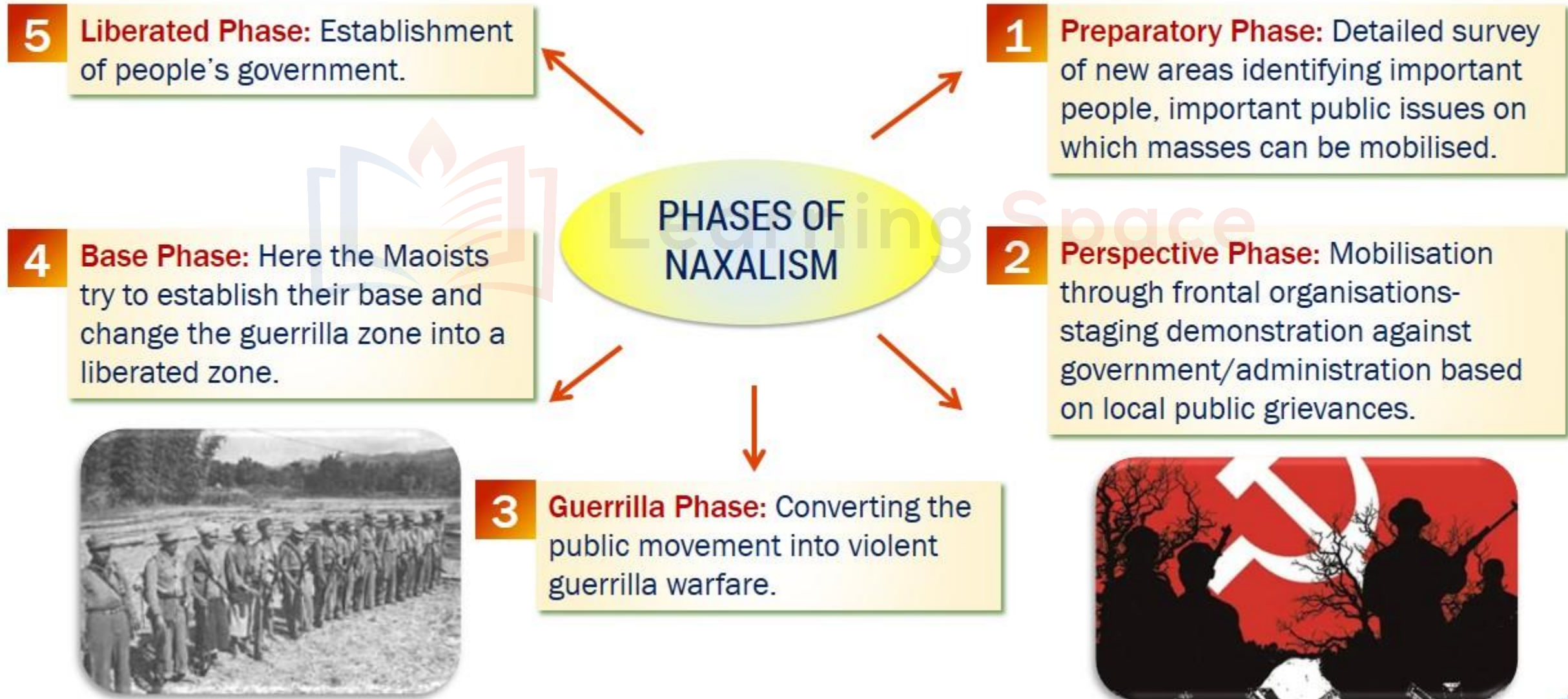
2

Military Strategies: Guerrilla war tactics in which a small group of combatants ambush a larger army.



LEFT-WING EXTREMISM

PHILOSOPHICAL BACKGROUND OF NAXALISM AND MAOISM



EVOLUTION OF NAXALISM IN INDIA

FIRST STAGE

- 1** Began in 1967 in Naxalbari in Darjeeling district of West Bengal.
- 2** All India Coordination Committee on Communist Revolutionaries (AICCCR) was formed in 1968.
- 3** It declared four ideological aims:
 - Protracted People's War in accordance with Mao's teachings.
 - Adapting to guerrilla warfare tactics.
 - Establishment of rural revolutionary base areas.
 - Encircling the cities as well as abstaining from parliamentary elections.
- 4** AICCCR founded the revolutionary party CPI Marxist-Leninist (ML) in 1969.
- 5** The period from 1970 to mid 1971 was the peak period of violent activities by Naxalites.
- 6** The movement faced a severe blow during emergency when around 40,000 cadres were imprisoned in 1975.



EVOLUTION OF NAXALISM IN INDIA

SECOND STAGE



- 1 The movement arose again in a more violent form after the Emergency. It continued to widen its base as per the strategy of protracted war.

- 2 Their base grew from West Bengal to Bihar to Odisha and also to Andhra Pradesh and Chhattisgarh.

- 3 CPI(ML) was converted into People's War Group in 1980 which had its base in Andhra Pradesh and struck heavy casualties among police personnel.

- 4 Simultaneously, Maoist Communist Centre of India (MCCI) grew in strength in Bihar and carried out large scale attacks on landlords and other upper caste outfits.

EVOLUTION OF NAXALISM IN INDIA

THIRD STAGE

1 In a significant development in 2004, the People's War Group, operating in Andhra Pradesh, and the Maoist Communist Centre of India, operating in Bihar and adjoining areas, merged to form the CPI Maoist.

2 Estimated to be 40,000 strong the Naxalites have been a strain on security forces and the barrier to development in the vast mineral rich region in eastern India.

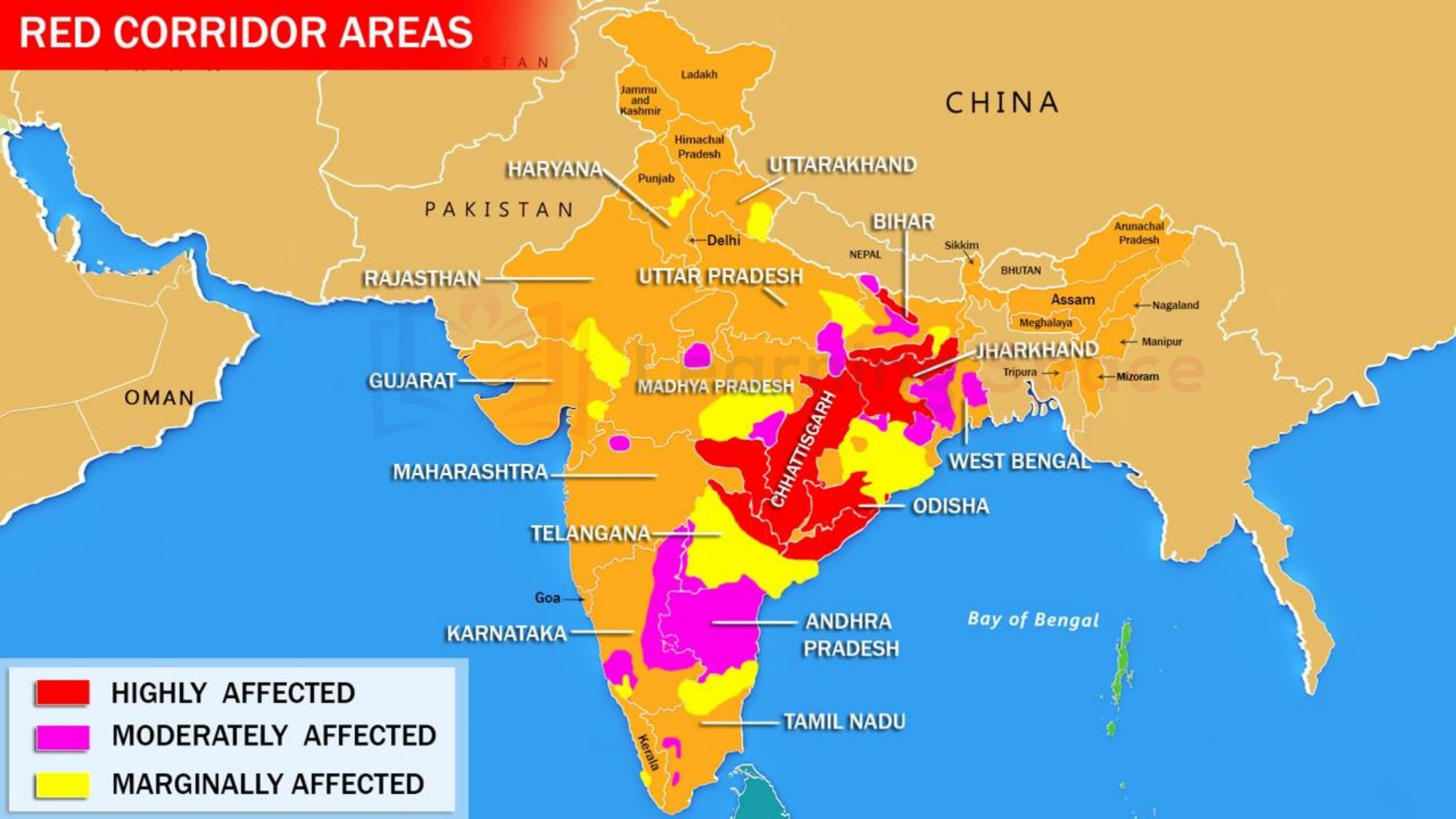
3 This region is known as the Red Corridor which is a narrow but contiguous strip passing through Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Odisha. In fact, at the peak of the Maoist movement in Nepal, Naxal influence was seen to be spreading from Tirupati to Pashupati.

4 The worst affected areas of the Maoist influence include approximately 30 districts of seven states namely Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Jharkhand, Bihar and West Bengal.

5 Most of the areas fall in the Dandakaranya region, which includes areas of Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra.

6 Maoists are also expanding in terms of indoctrination and consolidation. They are also trying to spread their ideology in the Bheel and Gond tribes nominated area – the “Golden Corridor” stretching from Pune to Ahmedabad.

RED CORRIDOR AREAS



MODUS OPERANDI OF THE NAXALITES

The aim of the Naxalites is to destroy the legitimacy of the state and to create a mass base, with a certain degree of acceptability. While impeding development works and challenging state authority, the Naxalites simultaneously try to derive benefit from the overall under-development of Governmental institutions.



ROAD TRANSPORT



POWER TRANSMISSION



SEZ POLICY



LAND REFORMS



LAND ACQUISITION



INDUSTRIAL INFRA

MODUS OPERANDI OF THE NAXALITES



GUERRILLA WARFARE

Military tactics including ambushes, sabotage, raids, petty warfare, hit-and-run tactics, and extraordinary mobility to fight a larger and lesser mobile traditional army.



POWERFUL PROPAGANDA MACHINERY

Naxalites try to be on the right side of the media all the time. They have their sympathisers everywhere who raise a hue and cry in the name of human rights against police action on the Maoists.



TACTICAL COUNTER OFFENSIVE CAMPAIGN

Maoists carry out activities called TCOC which runs from March to early monsoon in July. This is a recruitment drive undertaken by the Maoists.



FACTORS RESPONSIBLE FOR THE RISE OF LWE

1 India's land reform policy:

- Post-independence, the land reform policy could not be successful in some parts of the nation leading to the birth and growth of Naxal movement.

2 Development projects and tribal alienation:

- Resource mismanagement and systematic marginalisation of tribals in the name of public good.
- Conflict between economic progress and aboriginal land rights.
- Arundhati Roy said, that the tribal forest land should be called as "MoUist Corridor" instead of Maoist Corridor.

3 Forest protection Act of 1980:

- Although the legislation was an attempt to protect country's natural resources from exploitation, it outlawed the existence of many tribal villages.
- As areas were delineated as reserve forests, even traditional occupations were forbidden.
- This led to increase animosity towards the Government.

4 Development deficit and economic inequality:

- Non-diversified economic activity solely dependent on primary sector.
- Exploitation of natural resources leading to deprivation and displacement of tribals

5 Social conditions:

- Red corridor areas have stratified society with caste and feudal divisions which aggravate the friction.

6 Governance deficit:

- Lack of education facilities
- Infrastructure deficit
- Poor implementation of special laws
- Lack of routine administration
- Poorly motivated public officials
- Corruption in Government schemes

7 Inability of the tribal leaders to get their grievances addressed by the formal political system.

8 Geographical factors:

- Terrain suitable for guerrilla tactics
- Postings of officials termed as “punishment postings”



FRESH STRATEGY OF THE MAOISTS

6 For example, national secretary of PUCL Sudha Bhardwaj and Supreme Court lawyer Arun Ferreira were arrested in the Bhima-Koregaon violence case.

5 Such organisations malign the state institutions through systematic propaganda and disinformation campaigns to further their cause.

4 These organisations are generally manned by ideologues that include academicians and activists, mostly operating under the garb of human rights NGOs.



1 The fresh strategy is to expand outside the forest into the urban areas and win over the non-peasant classes.

2 They use Front Organisations mainly in urban areas to mobilise certain targeted sections of the urban population, recruit intellectual revolutionaries.

3 They raise funds for insurgency and create urban shelters for underground cadres and maintain separate identities from their parent party structure to avoid legal action.



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suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

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0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

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